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Va. Voters' Guide '98: County Board

The winner will serve a four-year term on the board. The incumbent, Christopher E. Zimmerman (D), was elected in January 1996 in a special election to fill an unexpired term. He is opposed by Republican Michael D. Lane.

OTHER VIRGINIA RACES | BACKGROUND ON THIS RACE

Incumbents' names are marked with asterisks. Web site and email addresses appear in the form in which they were submitted by the candidates.

THE CANDIDATES

Michael D. Lane

Republican

Age: 46

Residence: Arlington County.

Married: No.

Children: None.

Education: BA, political science, St. Anselm College, N.H.

Occupation/Employer: Management consultant, self-employed.

Elected Offices and Civic Activities: Secretary and board of directors, Arlington Optimists Club; Arlington Civic Federation; Citizens Crime Prevention Council; Arlington NAACP; Arlington Chamber of Commerce; American Legion Post 139; Arlingtonians for a Better County; Columbia Pike Revitalization Organization.

Why should voters elect you?

"Arlington needs fresh ideas to solve problems generated by 15 years of one-party rule. One party holds all 22 locally elected offices. Unanimous votes are cast 99.1 percent of the time. Monopoly rule has led to neglect of basic needs. Gang crime is increasing and schools are overcrowded. The achievement test failure rate at one school is 50 percent. Neighborhoods such as Arna Valley have decayed, while other neighborhoods suffer from

failure to solve traffic and in-fill development problems. I will be an independent voice asking your now-unasked questions to ensure a better quality of life for ALL Arlingtonians."

What do you want voters to know about you?

"I'm saddened by the decline in some schools and neighborhoods over the last 15 years. I have higher expectations for Arlington-that's why I'm running."

Web site: www.geocities.com/~mikelane98

Email: MichaelDLane@prodigy.com

Christopher Zimmerman*

Democrat

Age: 39

Residence: Arlington County.

Married: Yes.

Children: Three.

Education: MA, economics, University of Maryland; BS, economics/political science, American University.

Occupation/Employer: Arlington County Board, chairman.

Elected Offices and Civic Activities: Member of Arlington County Board since 1996; currently member of the following: WMATA of Arlington County Board of Directors; Northern Virginia Transportation Commission, Transportation Coordinating Council; Virginia Municipal League Committee on Public Safety. Active in Arlington Committee of 100, Arlingtonians for a Better County, Columbia Pike Revitalization Organization, Kiwanis, Arlington Historical Society.

Why should voters elect you?

"I am the only candidate with the proven record of experience necessary to lead Arlington into the 21st century. As board chairman, my vigorous examination of the budget enabled Arlington to maintain the lowest tax burden in the area, without jeopardizing our high-quality services and double/triple-A bond rating. As a Neighborhood Conservation Advisory Committee chair, I gained an appreciation for the strength and diversity of Arlington's neighborhoods. That's why this year I led the board to expand community policing countywide and implement neighborhood traffic-calming measures. I have also strongly supported needed funding for Arlington's schools."

What do you want voters to know about you?

"I believe that, with the right efforts, Arlington can be the model of an urban village, the standard for livability in the 21st century."

Web site: www.dgsys.com/arldem/reelectchris.html

Email: czmbz@erols.com

The Voters' Guide was compiled from staff reporting and information provided by the candidates in response to questionnaires from The Washington Post. Each candidate was asked to provide biographical information, a photograph and a brief statement about why the voters should elect him or her. Candidates' responses were edited for length and style.

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